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THE BLACK PANTHER

INTERCOMMUNAL NEWS SERVICE

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

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VOL. XVII NO. 22 SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 19, 1977

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"Hollow Promise" WATERED-DOWN FULL EMPLOYMENT BILL PROVIDES NO NEW JOBS

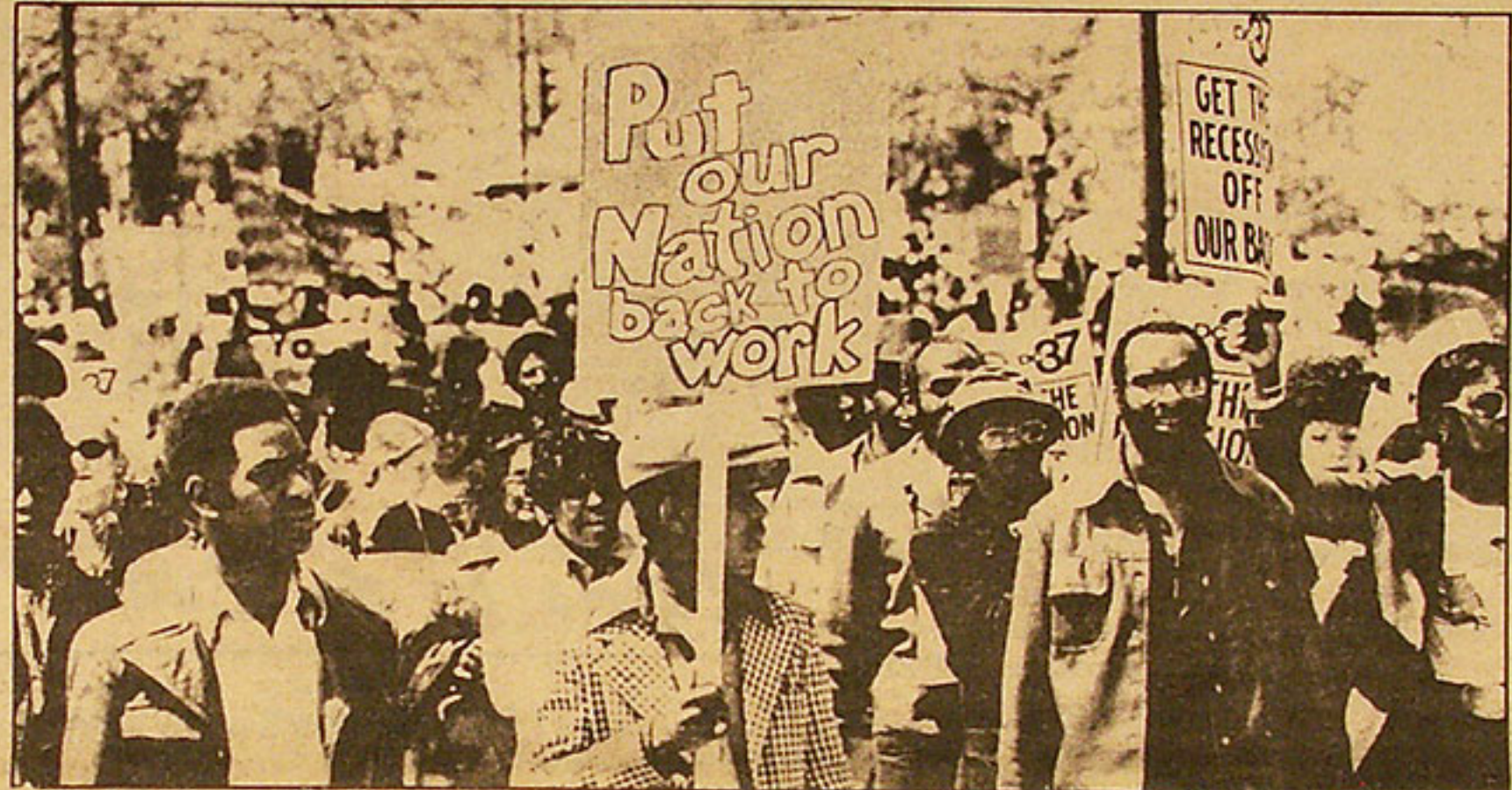
NOV 28 1977

(Washington, D.C.) - President Carter last week unveiled a compromise version of the controversial Humphrey-Hawkins full employment bill - but in such a watered-down form that it will do almost nothing to achieve the original goal of requiring the federal government to assure a job for every American who wants one.

Titled "The Full Employment and Balanced Growth Act of 1977," the proposed legislation neither creates new jobs nor does it mandate any specific government programs to lower skyrocketing rates of unemployment.

Overall unemployment in October, 1977, was 7.0 per cent, with the figure leaping to 13.9 per cent for the Black community as a whole, and to 37.9 per cent for Black teenagers aged 16 to 19. These figures do not take into account the hundreds of thousands of American people who have given up looking for work and dropped out of the job market.

As presented last week by Carter, the measure, which carries the name of Senator Hubert Humphrey of Minnesota and Representative Augustus Hawkins of California, would set a national goal of reducing unemployment from 7 per cent to 4 per cent in



Black and poor people are demanding more job opportunities. Recent legislation signed by President Carter will do nothing concrete to create badly-needed jobs.

1983, with a target of 3 per cent for all adults 20 years old and over.

Yet the legislation does not authorize particular programs to achieve these goals.

So watered-down is the present version, reached after months of negotiations between Carter administration officials and Congress-

Language, Mathematics Emphasized At Model School COMMUNITY SCHOOL PROVIDES INNOVATIVE TESTING

(Oakland, Calif.) - In a city whose predominantly Black public school students scored among the lowest in the state on standardized reading and mathematics tests taken last year (see article, page 3), one nonpublic school, for the seventh year in a row, is producing Black and poor youth whose language and math skills rank two to three grade levels above those of their public school peers.

The model elementary level Oakland Community School (OCS), in the words of a special commendation received from the California legislature this past August, has "...concretely defied the myth of the uneducable child..." and obtained "...the highest level of scholastic achievement in elementary education."

In an interview with THE BLACK PANTHER last week, OCS Director Ericka Huggins provided some insight into the innovative educational philosophy of the OCS and the invaluable contribution it is making to elementary education in this country.

Explaining the emphasis in the OCS



Children receive individual attention at the Oakland Community School.

curriculum, Ericka, who serves as the only Black member of the Alameda County Board of Education, said:

"We are very, very firm about our language

arts (reading, writing, spelling, and speaking) and mathematics classes. All of the 160 children, ages 2½ to 11, in our school take these subjects five days a week.

"Children, Black children in particular, have to master language and have an understanding of basic mathematics computation in order to survive in this country," Ericka emphasized. "Since Black people have been in America, these skills have been denied to us."

The OCS Language Arts Department has devised a reading program that is geared to the individual needs of each child. Children are regularly evaluated in silent and oral reading comprehension skills to determine their reading level and any special problems they may have.

As a result, language instructors for the 16 levels in the school are able to construct a reading program for each child that will enable him or her to progress at that individual's own speed.

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